

Document	HSE-04 Incident & Accident Reporting Procedure
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Incident & Accident Reporting Procedure

1. Purpose and scope

This procedure explains what to do when something goes wrong, or nearly goes wrong, at work: who to tell, how quickly and on which form. Fast and honest reporting lets us look after anyone who is hurt, meet our legal duties and stop the same thing happening again.

1.1 Who this applies to

The procedure applies to all employees, agency workers and contractors at our Leeds, Doncaster and Hull sites, to drivers wherever they are working, and to office staff working from home under HR-05. Visitors who are hurt on our sites should be reported by the person who is looking after them.

1.2 Why reporting matters

For every serious accident there are usually many smaller incidents and near misses that pointed to the same problem. We want to hear about those. Reporting an incident is never, in itself, a reason for disciplinary action. Failing to report one, or asking someone else not to report one, is.

2. What to report

2.1 Accidents

An accident is any event at work that causes an injury or ill health, however minor. This includes cuts, strains from lifting, slips and trips, and injuries that only show up later, such as back pain after moving a heavy pallet.

2.2 Near misses

A near miss is an event that could have caused an injury or damage but did not, often by luck. Examples are a pallet falling from racking into an empty aisle, a forklift reversing past a pedestrian with only inches to spare, or a load shifting in a trailer during braking.

2.3 Dangerous occurrences and damage

Report any fire, however small, any spill of fuel, oil or chemicals, any collapse of racking or failure of lifting equipment, and any damage to buildings, vehicles or customer goods caused by our work.

2.4 Road traffic collisions

Any collision involving a company vehicle must be reported, including low-speed knocks in yards and car parks and incidents where our vehicle was hit while parked. Section 5 explains what to do.

3. Immediate actions

3.1 Make the area safe and get help

Your first job is to stop anyone else getting hurt. Switch off machinery, stop traffic in the yard if needed and keep people away. If anyone is seriously injured, or there is a fire or a large spill, call 999 first and then follow section 4.1.

3.2 First aid

Every depot has trained first aiders on every shift. Their names are on the noticeboard next to each first aid kit. Every company vehicle carries a first aid kit. Do not move an injured person unless they are in immediate danger.

3.3 Keep the scene as it is

Unless it is unsafe, leave equipment, vehicles and loads where they are until a manager has seen them and taken photos. Keep any damaged equipment out of use and label it clearly.

4. Reporting deadlines

4.1 Immediately, by phone

The following must be reported by phone as soon as it is safe to do so: a death, an injury that needs hospital treatment, a fire, a large spill, a collapse of racking and any collision in which someone is hurt. Phone the Duty Manager at your site and the Health, Safety & Environment Manager on ext. 250. Out of hours, or if you are on the road, phone the Transport Planning Office on ext. 100, who will contact the managers on call.

4.2 Before the end of the shift

Every accident, dangerous occurrence and case of damage must be recorded on form HSE-1 before the end of the shift in which it happened. If the injured person cannot complete the form, their line manager or a witness completes it. If an injury only becomes clear later, report it as soon as you realise.

4.3 Within 24 hours

Near misses must be reported on form HSE-2 within 24 hours. The form takes about five minutes and can be filled in on a handheld, a PC or on paper in the depot office. You can report a near miss anonymously if you prefer.

4.4 Reports to the regulator

Some injuries, diseases and dangerous occurrences are reportable to the regulator where the law requires. The Health, Safety & Environment Manager decides whether an incident is reportable and makes the report. Our internal target is to make that decision, and any report, within 10 days of the incident. Line managers must tell the Health, Safety & Environment Manager as soon as an injured person has been off work, or unable to do their normal job, for more than 3 days.

5. Collisions in company vehicles

5.1 At the scene

If you are involved in a collision in a company vehicle:

- stop as soon as it is safe, switch on hazard lights and put on your high-visibility vest;
- call 999 if anyone is injured or the road is blocked;
- do not admit fault or discuss who was to blame;
- exchange names, addresses, vehicle registrations and insurance details with the other driver;
- take photos of all vehicles, the road layout and any damage with your handheld;
- take names and phone numbers of any witnesses;
- use the collision pack in the cab, which includes form HSE-RTC and a card with the company's insurance details.

5.2 Calling it in

Phone the Transport Planning Office on ext. 100 as soon as it is safe, and in any case within 30 minutes of the collision. They will tell you whether to continue, arrange recovery or a replacement vehicle and make sure the in-cab camera footage is saved.

5.3 Police reports

If you could not exchange details at the scene, for example because you hit a parked car and the owner could not be found, or if anyone was injured and you did not give your insurance details, you must report the collision to the police in person as soon as possible and in any case within 24 hours. Give the police reference number to the Transport Planning Office.

5.4 Paperwork and testing

Complete form HSE-RTC before the end of your shift and hand it to the depot office with your photos. You will be asked to take a drug and alcohol test as set out in OPS-02, section 5.4. Do not post about the collision on social media or discuss it with anyone except the police, our insurers and the investigating manager.

6. Investigation

6.1 Who investigates

Minor accidents and near misses are investigated by the line manager of the area where they happened. Any injury needing hospital treatment, any incident reportable to the regulator and any dangerous occurrence is investigated by the Health, Safety & Environment Manager. Every collision involving a company vehicle is investigated by the Fleet Safety Manager, with support from the Health, Safety & Environment Manager where someone was hurt.

6.2 Timescales

Line managers complete their investigation within 5 working days. Investigations led by the Health, Safety & Environment Manager or the Fleet Safety Manager produce a written report within 14 days of the incident, with actions, owners and target dates.

6.3 Fair and open reporting

Investigations look for causes, not someone to blame. Most incidents come from how work is planned, equipment or layout, rather than one person's mistake. Disciplinary action is only considered where someone deliberately broke a safety rule or acted recklessly, and that is handled separately under HR-01.

7. Records and learning

7.1 Records

All HSE-1, HSE-2 and HSE-RTC forms and investigation reports are held by the Health, Safety & Environment Manager for at least 6 years. Personal details are only shared with those who need them.

7.2 Sharing lessons

A summary of incidents, near misses and actions is reviewed at the monthly safety meeting at each depot and shared on the noticeboards. Anyone who reported a near miss will be told what was done about it.